



Security Council

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Letter dated 7 March 2023 from the President of the Security Council addressed to the Secretary-General

Further to the letter dated 25 January 2023 from Ambassador Ishikane Kimihiro, I have the honour to confirm that the members of the Security Council have agreed to carry out a mission to the Democratic Republic of the Congo from 9 to 12 March 2023 under the Security Council presidency of Mozambique. The members of the Council have also agreed on the terms of reference of the mission, which are annexed hereto (see annex).

The mission will be co-led by Ambassador Nicolas de Rivière (France) and Ambassador Michel Xavier Biang (Gabon).

Following consultations with the members, it has been agreed that the composition of the mission will be as follows:

Ambassador Ferit Hoxha (Albania)
Mr. Cícero Tobias de Oliveira Freitas (Brazil)
Mr. Sun Zhiqiang (China)
Ambassador Hernán Pérez Loose (Ecuador)
Ambassador Nicolas de Rivière (France)
Ambassador Michel Xavier Biang (Gabon)
Ms. Nana Akua Barnor (Ghana)
Ambassador Ishikane Kimihiro (Japan)
Ambassador Vanessa Frazier (Malta)
Ambassador Pedro Commisário Afonso (Mozambique)
Ambassador Anna M. Evstigneeva (Russian Federation)
Ambassador Pascale Christine Baeriswyl (Switzerland)
Ambassador Mohamed Issa Abushahab (United Arab Emirates)
Mr. Fergus John Eckersley (United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland)
Ambassador Robert A. Wood (United States of America)

I should be grateful if you could have the present letter and its annex circulated as a document of the Security Council.

(Signed) Pedro Commisário Afonso
President of the Security Council



Annex

Terms of reference of the Security Council mission to the Democratic Republic of the Congo, 9 to 12 March 2023

1. The Security Council will carry out a mission to the Democratic Republic of the Congo during the Security Council presidency of Mozambique from 9 to 12 March 2023 within the framework of resolutions [2666 \(2022\)](#) and [2667 \(2022\)](#) and statement by the President [S/PRST/2021/19](#).
2. The members of the mission will seek to meet the President of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, members of the Government and leaders of the main political groupings and parties, as well as civil society organizations, including women and youth civil society organizations, and representatives of relevant regional organizations, the East African Community regional force, the United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO), the United Nations country team and other United Nations entities, and humanitarian actors.
3. The mission will be co-led by France and Gabon.
4. The objectives of the mission are as follows:
 - (a) To assess the security situation in the Democratic Republic of the Congo and the efforts of MONUSCO to implement its mandate in accordance with resolution [2666 \(2022\)](#) and, in particular, to respond to current and ongoing security threats;
 - (b) To assess responses to persistent violence in some parts of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, in particular Ituri, North Kivu and South Kivu, as well as regarding the humanitarian situation in the country, and to encourage further efforts to hold accountable perpetrators of violence against civilians, including against children, and to combat and prevent sexual violence in conflict and post-conflict situations;
 - (c) To demand that all armed groups cease immediately all forms of violence, other destabilizing activities and the illegal exploitation and trafficking of natural resources, as well as to demand the immediate withdrawal of the Mouvement du 23 mars (M23) from all occupied areas as agreed through the African Union-endorsed Luanda process, and to call for an immediate end to all external support to non-State armed actors, including the M23;
 - (d) To support regional efforts to promote peace and stability, including the East African Community-led Nairobi process and the African Union-mandated mediation under the aegis of Angola, and to assess the level of coordination and information-sharing between the East African Community regional force, the Armed Forces of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, the Burundi National Defence Force, the Uganda People's Defence Forces and MONUSCO, including to deconflict operations and ensure the protection of civilians and the implementation of the MONUSCO mandate;
 - (e) To encourage the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo to take further action against individuals and organizations that engage in the illegal exploitation of natural resources;
 - (f) To assess efforts of the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo to ensure the safe and effective management, storage, marking, monitoring and security of the national stockpiles of weapons and ammunition, as well as efforts to fight arms trafficking and diversion;

(g) To reiterate the full support of the members of the Security Council for MONUSCO and the Special Representative of the Secretary-General for the Democratic Republic of the Congo in efficiently implementing their mandate in full, including with regard to strategic communications, and to strongly encourage all parties to respect the safety and security of United Nations peacekeepers;

(h) To assess the progress made by the United Nations and the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, in liaison with civil society, to identify the concrete and realistic steps to be undertaken, as a matter of priority, to create the minimum security conditions to enable the responsible and sustainable exit of MONUSCO and engage the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo on the review of the joint transition plan and the upcoming options for adapting MONUSCO and United Nations configurations to be presented by the Secretary-General, as requested in resolution [2666 \(2022\)](#);

(i) To assess the efforts of the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, with the support of MONUSCO and other international partners, to implement the Disarmament, Demobilization, Community Recovery and Stabilization Programme and to advance security sector reform;

(j) To assess and encourage efforts of the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo to hold accountable any actor responsible for violations of international humanitarian law or violations and abuses of human rights, as applicable, in particular those that may amount to war crimes and crimes against humanity, and to assess efforts of MONUSCO and the Government to counter hate speech, disinformation and misinformation;

(k) To encourage all political stakeholders to continue to work, with the support of MONUSCO, towards peaceful, transparent, inclusive and credible processes for the presidential and legislative elections scheduled in 2023, in accordance with the Constitution and the electoral law, throughout the Democratic Republic of the Congo, to facilitate free and fair elections, to ensure the full, equal, effective and meaningful participation of women at all stages and to reaffirm the important role of young people in electoral processes;

(l) To exchange views with the United Nations and authorities on the humanitarian situation in the Democratic Republic of the Congo, including humanitarian access and efforts to protect refugees and internally displaced persons, and to enhance complementarity between humanitarian, development and peace efforts and actors.

5. The mission may hold a commemorative ceremony to pay tribute to the peacekeepers who have lost their lives while serving in MONUSCO.

6. The mission will seek to implement lessons learned from previous Security Council missions, including with regard to modalities of association of representatives from relevant regional organizations.